

TAM — Traceability & Audit Module

Canonical Definition

Traceability & Audit defines the requirement that all decisions, actions, and system events must be recorded, attributable, and reconstructable to ensure verifiable accountability.

A system is not trustworthy if its actions cannot be traced and reconstructed.

Purpose

This module ensures that:

- every decision can be traced to its origin
 - every action is attributable to a responsible entity
 - system behavior can be reconstructed at any time
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Core Principle

If it cannot be traced, it cannot be verified.
If it cannot be verified, it cannot be trusted.

Minimum Implementation Framework (MIF)

The system MUST ensure:

1. Decision Recording

All decisions MUST be:

- recorded
 - stored in a persistent form
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2. Time-Stamping

All records MUST include:

- exact time of decision or action
 - sequence consistency
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3. Attribution

Every decision MUST be:

- linked to an identifiable entity
 - connected to a defined responsibility holder
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4. Reconstruction Capability

The system MUST enable:

- full reconstruction of decision flow
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- step-by-step trace of actions
 - verification of system behavior
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5. Audit Accessibility

The system **MUST** allow:

- audit access (internal or external)
 - verification of records
 - consistency checks
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Mandatory Conditions

- all decisions **MUST** be recorded
 - records **MUST** be attributable
 - records **MUST** be time-consistent
 - system **MUST** support reconstruction
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Prohibited Conditions

- missing decision records
 - anonymous actions
 - incomplete or inconsistent logs
 - inability to reconstruct system behavior
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Output

The system produces:

Verifiable Audit Trail

Reconstructable Decision History

System Condition

- **Valid** → full traceability and reconstruction possible
 - **Invalid** → missing or unverifiable records
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Use Case 1 — Incident Investigation

Without module:

- actions unclear
- no trace of decisions

With module:

- full history available
- responsible entity identified

Result:

- accountability enforced
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Use Case 2 — AI Decision Audit

Without module:

- AI outputs cannot be traced
- no explanation of actions

With module:

- decision path recorded
- actions attributable

Result:

- AI becomes auditable
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Closing Insight

If a system cannot explain what happened, it is not under control.

Related Documents

[→ CGRM Standard](#)

[→ CGRM Modules Overview](#)

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Canonical Source

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